

Top 10 games this week · for the playoff field

Week 1 · 2026 season · data Sep 3 · SP+ 2026
0 locks · 1 likely · 11 on the bubble

THE FIELD RIGHT NOW

0 locks (90%+), 1 likely (75–90%), 11 on the bubble (25–75%). Projected field: Ohio St, Notre Dame, Oregon, Georgia, Indiana, Texas Tech, Texas, Miami, LSU, Texas A&M, BYU, Boise St.

Ranked by leverage · how often the result changes who makes the 12-team field, discounted by how unlikely the swing is

1	Mon, Sep 7 · 1930 ET · ESPN	Leverage 68	Impact 61
#19 SMU (52%) at Florida State (48%) SMU -3 · O/U 53.5			
Changes who makes the field in 20.0% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: SMU (61%), Florida State (27%), Miami (13%).			
2	Sat, Sep 5 · 1930 ET · ABC	Leverage 51	Impact 56
Clemson (28%) at #11 LSU (72%) LSU -10 · O/U 50.5			
Changes who makes the field in 18.4% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: LSU (56%), Clemson (39%), Texas (5%).			
3	Sun, Sep 6 · 1930 ET · ABC	Leverage 42	Impact 41
#24 Louisville (37%) at #9 Ole Miss (63%) Ole Miss -6.5 · O/U 55.5			
Changes who makes the field in 13.3% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Ole Miss (54%), Louisville (38%), Georgia (5%).			
4	Sat, Sep 5 · 2200 ET · CW	Leverage 32	Impact 30
UNLV (60%) at Hawai'i (40%) UNLV -3 · O/U 55.5			
Changes who makes the field in 9.7% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: UNLV (63%), Hawai'i (18%), North Dakota State (9%).			
5	Sat, Sep 5 · 1200 ET · ESPNU	Leverage 27	Impact 27
Liberty (34%) at James Madison (66%) James Madison -6 · O/U 50.5			
Changes who makes the field in 8.8% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: James Madison (59%), Liberty (43%), Boise State (7%).			
6	Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · ESPN	Leverage 26	Impact 73
#7 Miami (91%) at Stanford (9%) Miami -24.5 · O/U 48.5			
Changes who makes the field in 23.8% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Miami (74%), SMU (11%), Louisville (10%).			
7	Sun, Sep 6 · 1930 ET · NBC	Leverage 17	Impact 50
Wisconsin (8%) at #4 Notre Dame (92%) Notre Dame -20.5 · O/U 46.5			
Changes who makes the field in 16.5% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Notre Dame (81%), Wisconsin (10%), Miami (4%).			
8	Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · ABC	Leverage 17	Impact 17
Baylor (32%) at Auburn (68%) Auburn -7.5 · O/U 59.5			
Changes who makes the field in 5.6% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Auburn (59%), Baylor (24%), Georgia (5%).			
9	Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · FOX	Leverage 16	Impact 39
Fresno State (10%) at #14 USC (90%) USC -22.5 · O/U 51.5			
Changes who makes the field in 12.9% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: USC (69%), Fresno State (23%), Indiana (5%).			
10	Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · CBS	Leverage 15	Impact 63
Boise State (6%) at #2 Oregon (94%) Oregon -24.5 · O/U 51.5			
Changes who makes the field in 20.5% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Oregon (54%), Boise State (40%), USC (4%).			

Leverage and impact are scaled 0–100 against the biggest remaining game. Win chances from SP+ with home advantage; every number from 30,000 simulated seasons with each game flipped one at a time.